

eyecatchers

COMIC CAPERS

After exploring possibly everything on television from acting to VJ-ing to hosting shows and doing bit roles in films like *Fanaa*, **Shruti Seth**, 30, is getting ready for the real deal on 70 mm. The actor, who till recently couldn't stop laughing on *Comedy Circus*, has been paired opposite Rajpal Yadav in the comedy *Khalbali*. Seth plays a woman holidaying in Bangkok, who falls in love with the hit-man hired to kill her. "While working with Rajpal, I learnt the importance of being natural. It's particularly difficult to pull off comedy without going over the top," she says, dead serious.



STAGE BEAUTY

She's practically grown up on the stage. Theatre and film actress **Lillette Dubey's** younger daughter **Ira** majored in theatre studies at Yale and has been a regular on the Mumbai circuit since her return. The 25-year-old has now given in to the charms of Bollywood and will make her big screen debut in Rohan Sippy's next production, *The President is Coming*. "I've known director Kunaal Roy Kapoor, for a long time. I got a call from him and he wanted me to read for this film, which is based on a play," says Ira, who plays a girl who runs her own cosmetics empire. Ira is considering other films, but says "theatre will remain not only a passion, but my priority". Take a bow.

Singh Song

It's become the hottest accessory of the season. After Akshay Kumar raked in the crores in a *pagdi*, at least two other actors are donning the turban. Promos of Salman Khan as a Sikh in the film *Heroes* are already doing the rounds and curious onlookers in Kolkata recently spotted **Saif Ali Khan** in a crimson *pagdi*. The actor was in character for his own untitled home production being directed by Imtiaz Ali. "I had a Jat Sikh boy in mind even when I was writing this love story, since I love Punjabi culture," says 36-year-old Ali, adding that Saif was thrilled to play a Sikh for the first time. Donning many hats, eh?



SANTANU SARKAR

Second Time Lucky

She was supposed to direct Madhuri Dixit for her debut film. But when that did not work out, actor **Deepti Naval** moved on, directing her first film *Do Paise Ki Dhoop, Chaar Aane Ki Baarish*. "The film is shot in Mumbai in the monsoons," says Naval, adding that it is about the intimate relationships between three characters. While close friend Manisha Koirala plays the female lead, Rajit Kapoor and a young boy from New York play the other key characters. Let the credits roll.





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